

Rockdale, TX

IT MSP — 60-Day Launch Plan

Solo operator startup plan covering legal setup, lean software stack, go-to-market strategy, client onboarding, and required forms.

Target MRR (Day 60)	Monthly Stack Cost	Service Territory	Break-even Clients
\$3,000 – \$8,000	~\$524/mo	60-mi radius (HWY 79)	2 – 3 clients

Market context: Rockdale (pop. ~5,600) sits at the intersection of HWY 79 and HWY 77, surrounded by ~210 local businesses. A 3,300-acre Advanced Manufacturing & Logistics Center is under construction 5 miles west, and a Samsung plant is incoming nearby — creating a first-mover opportunity for IT support across incoming industrial tenants. Primary client verticals: construction, medical/dental, retail, and agriculture. Service radius covers Cameron, Taylor, Georgetown, and Temple.

Confirmed Software Stack

Tool	Category	Monthly Cost	Notes
Syncro	RMM + PSA	\$129/mo	1 tech, unlimited devices. Replaces NinjaOne + HaloPSA.
Huntress	Security / EDR	~\$150/mo	50 endpoints @ ~\$3/ea. MSP partner rate. 24/7 SOC included.
DNSFilter	DNS Filtering	\$150/mo	MSP minimum covers all clients. Replaces Cisco Umbrella.
Acronis (Pax8)	Backup & DR	~\$25/mo	Per-workload via Pax8. 50–70% cheaper than direct pricing.
Hudu	IT Documentation	~\$35/mo	1 user. Network discovery add-on recommended.
QuickBooks Online	Accounting	\$35/mo	Simple Start. Handles business accounting.
HubSpot CRM	CRM / Sales Pipeline	\$0	Free forever plan. Unlimited contacts, deal pipeline, email tracking.
TOTAL		~\$524/mo	At startup scale (~50 managed endpoints).

Note: Syncro replaces both NinjaOne and HaloPSA. DNSFilter replaces Cisco Umbrella. All tools purchased via Pax8 distributor where applicable for MSP discount pricing.

Startup Expenses

One-time setup costs (Month 1)

Expense	Est. Cost	Notes
Texas LLC formation (SOS filing)	\$300	File online at sos.texas.gov
EIN registration	\$0	Free via IRS.gov online
Business insurance — GL + E&O;	\$1,500 – \$3,000/yr	~\$125–\$250/mo. Texas Farm Bureau or Hiscox recommended.
Domain name + Google Workspace	~\$180 – \$240/yr	Domain ~\$15/yr, Google Workspace ~\$14/user/mo
Business checking account	\$0	First National Bank Rockdale or Extraco Banks
MSA / SLA legal template review	\$200 – \$500	One-time attorney review. Use a Texas-based IT attorney.
Vehicle vinyl wrap / branding	\$500 – \$1,500	Rolling billboard on HWY 79. Highly recommended in rural TX.
Website (domain + basic hosting)	\$100 – \$300	Squarespace or Wix. 5 pages max at launch.
Business cards + print collateral	\$50 – \$150	Print-ready brochure. Many local owners prefer paper.
Pax8 distributor account	\$0	Free. Required before ordering Acronis or Umbrella.
TOTAL ONE-TIME	~\$2,950 – \$6,070	

Recurring monthly costs (ongoing)

Tool / Expense	Monthly Cost	Notes
Syncro (RMM + PSA)	\$129	1 tech license, unlimited endpoints
Huntress EDR	~\$150	~50 endpoints at MSP partner rate
DNSFilter	\$150	MSP minimum — covers entire client base
Acronis Cyber Protect Cloud	~\$25	~5 workloads via Pax8 at startup
Hudu (IT documentation)	~\$35	1 user, cloud-hosted
QuickBooks Online	\$35	Simple Start plan
HubSpot CRM	\$0	Free forever plan — upgrade optional later
Google Workspace (email)	~\$14	1 user at \$14/user/mo
Business insurance (monthly)	~\$167	Avg. of annual GL + E&O; estimate
Fuel / vehicle (field visits)	~\$150 – \$300	60-mi service radius, rural roads
Chamber of Commerce membership	~\$25	Rockdale Chamber annual ~\$300/yr
TOTAL MONTHLY (est.)	~\$880 – \$1,030	Before paying yourself

Break-even math: At \$500–\$600/mo per client (10–15 endpoints + services), you need 2–3 signed clients to cover your full stack. Your first client alone covers Syncro, HubSpot, and Hudu.

Month 1 — Build the Foundation

Legal setup · software stack · packaging · go-to-market

WEEK 1

Legal & Business Setup

- File Texas LLC with Secretary of State (sos.texas.gov) —
- Register EIN at IRS.gov — free, takes 10 minutes
- Open business checking at First National Bank Rockdale
- Secure general liability + E&O; insurance (Texas Farm B
- Purchase domain and set up Google Workspace (\$14/us
- Have MSA and SLA templates reviewed by a Texas IT a
- Contact Rockdale MDD (rockdalemdd.org) — grants and
- Create bilingual business cards (English + Spanish — 37

Tip: Contact the Temple SBDC (254-771-2310) — free consu

WEEK 2

Software Stack Setup

- Create free Pax8 distributor account first — required for Acronis MSP p
- Sign up for Syncro free trial (syncromsp.com) — 14 days, no credit card
- Sign up for Huntress free trial (huntress.com) — enroll in Partner Progra
- Order Acronis Cyber Protect Cloud through Pax8 — per-workload mode
- Sign up for DNSFilter MSP partner account (dnsfilter.com)
- Sign up for Hudu (hudu.com) — SaaS-hosted, 1 user
- Create HubSpot free account (hubspot.com) — add all prospect contact
- Set up QuickBooks Online Simple Start — connect to Stripe for auto-pa
- Install Syncro agent on your own machines to learn the platform first

Tip: Deploy Huntress agent via Syncro RMM policy — zero-touch rollout to al

WEEK 3

Service Packages & Pricing

- Define 2–3 service tiers priced for Milam County budgets
- Create 'Industrial Onboarding' package targeting Samsu
- Build one-page print-ready service brochure (many local
- Set competitive drive-time radius: 60 min covers Georget
- Pick primary niche vertical: construction firms are #1 emp
- Write standardized onboarding checklist — what you do
- Set up Syncro billing templates and contract automation
- Configure HubSpot deal pipeline stages: Prospect → Dis

Tip: Construction is Rockdale's #1 industry (470 workers). Th
absorb managed services.

WEEK 4

Go-to-Market & Local Outreach

- Launch simple website (5 pages max: Home, Services, About, Contact,
- Claim and optimize Google Business Profile for 'IT support Rockdale TX
- Join Rockdale Chamber of Commerce (1203 W Cameron Ave) — atten
- Introduce yourself to Milam County EDC and Temple SBDC
- Build prospect list in HubSpot: 40–60 local SMBs from downtown Rock
- Begin LinkedIn outreach targeting local business owners along HWY 79
- Schedule 5–10 discovery calls for Month 2
- Have vehicle vinyl wrap designed and ordered

Tip: Over 16,000 vehicles per day travel HWY 79 through Rockdale. A brand
best local ads.

✓ Texas LLC formed

✓ Full stack live

✓ Service packages ready

✓ HubSpot pipeline loaded

Month 2 — Land & Expand

Close first clients · onboard · build processes · plan for scale

WEEK 5

Close First Clients

- Run discovery calls — meet in person (small-town TX relationship is king)
- Document each prospect's pain points; log everything in Hududocs
- Send proposals using your MSA template; target 1–3 signatures per week
- Prioritize construction companies, medical/dental offices, manufacturers
- Collect signed contracts and set up automated billing in Syncro
- Set up ACH auto-pay — preferred by local business owners
- Move signed clients from HubSpot 'Won' stage into Syncro pipeline

Tip: Rockdale ISD is the largest employer (306 staff). Vendor to them to get prospects.

WEEK 6

Onboard & Deliver

- Show up on-site for all onboarding — clients expect face-to-face setup in person
- Deploy Syncro RMM agent to all client endpoints
- Deploy Huntress EDR via Syncro RMM policy — zero-touch across all endpoints
- Deploy DNSFilter roaming client to all managed devices
- Deploy Acronis backup agent; verify first successful restore before leaving
- Document full client environment in Hududocs: devices, passwords, network diagrams
- Run initial security assessment — most local SMBs have outdated Windows
- Expect legacy hardware and older software — budget time for remediation

Tip: Use Hududocs Radar (add-on) for automatic network discovery — invaluable for spaghetti networks.

WEEK 7

Processes & Automation

- Build patching policy in Syncro — automate Windows + third-party updates
- Configure Huntress alert policies — set pre-authorization for alerts
- Create monthly reporting template clients can read without a meeting
- Build ticket triage SOP: severity tiers, response times, escalation
- Develop 'Industrial IT' pitch deck for Samsung-area contractors
- Start attending Cameron and Taylor business events to visit clients
- Add all runbooks and SOPs to Hududocs wiki
- Document all Syncro automation scripts in Hududocs for future reference

Tip: The Advanced Manufacturing Center (5 mi west of Rockdale) is a goldmine. Get known now.

WEEK 8

Review & Scale Plan

- Deliver first client QBR or 30-day check-in — in person over coffee
- Ask for referrals — word of mouth is the #1 marketing channel in a town of 100
- Review MRR vs. stack costs in QuickBooks — cut any unused tools
- Assess capacity: how many more endpoints can you handle solo?
- Plan first hire or subcontractor if pipeline is growing faster than capacity
- Check A&M-Central; Texas (Killeen, ~45 min) and Temple College for IT grads
- Update HubSpot pipeline with referrals and new prospects from client network
- Evaluate upgrade path: when to move from Syncro to NinjaOne + HaloPaaS

Tip: A&M-Central; Texas and Temple College produce IT grads — your best subcontractor hire.

✓ First MRR signed

✓ Clients fully onboarded

✓ Industrial pitch ready

✓ 60-day review complete

Required Forms & Documents

The following forms should be created before signing your first client. Have a Texas-licensed IT attorney review the MSA and SLA before use.

01 Master Service Agreement (MSA)

When to use: Before any client engagement

- Business legal name and address (yours + client)
- Scope of services (reference your service tier)
- Payment terms (net 15 or net 30, auto-pay preferred)
- Service hours and emergency response policy
- Limitation of liability clause
- Data ownership and confidentiality terms
- Termination clause (30-day written notice minimum)
- Governing law: State of Texas

02 Service Level Agreement (SLA)

When to use: Attached to MSA; tier-specific

- Ticket response times by severity (P1: 1hr, P2: 4hr, P3: next business day)
- Uptime guarantee for monitored systems (e.g. 99.5%)
- Backup recovery time objective (RTO) and recovery point objective (RPO)
- Scheduled maintenance windows (e.g. Tuesday nights 10pm–2am)
- Exclusions (user error, acts of God, ISP outages)
- Reporting cadence (monthly summary delivered by 5th of following month)
- SLA breach remedies (service credits or escalation procedures)

03 Client Onboarding Questionnaire

When to use: Before first on-site visit

- Number of users and endpoints (desktops, laptops, servers, mobile)
- Current ISP provider, speeds, and router/firewall make/model
- Operating systems in use (Windows version, macOS, Linux)
- Line-of-business applications (accounting, CRM, industry-specific software)
- Current backup solution (if any) and last verified restore date
- Microsoft 365 or Google Workspace tenant details
- Previous IT provider contact info (for record transfer)
- Key staff contacts: IT point of contact, billing contact, decision-maker
- Known ongoing issues or complaints from prior IT support
- Physical security: server room access, lock policy, visitor policy

04 Network & Environment Assessment Form

When to use: During first on-site visit

- Network diagram sketch (switches, routers, APs, servers)
- IP address scheme and DHCP range
- Active Directory or Azure AD configuration
- All hardware with make, model, serial number, and age
- Software licenses in use (note expiry dates)
- Open firewall ports and VPN configurations
- Current antivirus / security software installed
- Shared drives and mapped network paths
- Printer and peripheral inventory
- Findings and risk rating (Low / Medium / High)

05 Monthly Client Report Template

When to use: Delivered by 5th of each month

- Executive summary (1 paragraph — written in plain English, not IT jargon)
- Endpoints monitored this month (count by type)
- Tickets opened, resolved, and pending (with avg. resolution time)
- Patches applied (count by OS and third-party)
- Backup status: all jobs successful? Any failures and resolutions?
- Huntress security summary: threats detected, contained, remediated
- DNSFilter summary: blocked requests, top categories blocked
- Recommended actions for next month (plain language)
- Your contact info and emergency line

06 New User / Offboarding Request Form

When to use: Submitted by client HR or manager

- Employee full name
- Start date (onboarding) or last day (offboarding)
- Job title and department
- Hardware needed: laptop, desktop, mobile device
- Software access required (list each application)
- Email address to create (or to disable)
- Microsoft 365 / Google Workspace license type
- Manager approving the request (signature required)
- For offboarding: data retention policy and equipment return instructions

07 Incident Response Report

When to use: Filed within 24 hours of any security incident

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- | | |
|---|--|
| ■ Date, time, and duration of incident | ■ Root cause analysis (preliminary) |
| ■ Systems affected (names, IPs, roles) | ■ Data impacted: type, volume, sensitivity level |
| ■ Incident type (ransomware, phishing, data breach, hardware failure, etc.) | ■ Client notification date and method |
| ■ Initial detection method (Huntress alert, user report, monitoring) | ■ Remediation steps and timeline |
| ■ Immediate containment steps taken | ■ Preventive measures recommended |

08 Change Request / Approval Form

When to use: Before any significant infrastructure change

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- | | |
|--|--------------------------------------|
| ■ Requested by (name, title, date) | ■ Rollback plan if change fails |
| ■ Change description (plain language summary) | ■ Scheduled maintenance window |
| ■ Systems affected | ■ Client sign-off (signature + date) |
| ■ Business justification | ■ Post-change verification steps |
| ■ Risk assessment: Low / Medium / High + explanation | ■ Completed by (tech name + date) |

Vendor Sign-up Sequence

Follow this order exactly. Pax8 must be active before purchasing Acronis or DNSFilter to access MSP distributor pricing.

#	Tool	When	Cost	Action
1	Pax8	Week 1, Day 1	\$0	pax8.com — free distributor account. Unlocks MSP pricing for Acronis, Cisco, and M365.
2	HubSpot CRM	Week 1, Day 2	\$0	hubspot.com — free forever. Load all 40–60 local prospects immediately.
3	QuickBooks Online	Week 1, Day 3	\$35/mo	quickbooks.intuit.com — Simple Start. Connect Stripe for client auto-pay.
4	Syncro	Week 2, Day 1	\$129/mo	syncromsp.com — 14-day free trial. Install agent on your own machines first.
5	Huntress	Week 2, Day 2	~\$150/mo	huntress.com — 14-day full-feature trial. Register as MSP partner for 50% off direct rate.
6	Acronis	Week 2, Day 3	~\$25/mo	Order via Pax8 — NOT direct. Choose per-workload model for small client base.
7	DNSFilter	Week 2, Day 4	\$150/mo	dnsfilter.com — MSP partner account. \$150/mo minimum covers entire client base.
8	Hudu	Week 2, Day 5	~\$35/mo	hudu.com — SaaS-hosted. Start documenting on Day 1 of every client onboard.

Upgrade path: This stack is designed to carry you to \$5K–\$8K MRR. When you hire your first tech, migrate RMM to NinjaOne and PSA to HaloPSA for deeper multi-tech management. HubSpot Free scales to 50+ active prospects; upgrade to HubSpot Starter (~\$15/mo) when you need email sequences and automation. All tools export data cleanly — no vendor lock-in.